

you don't have the time or the patience to compose a sonnet or play out a lengthy trial. Some of the players even get bored when there isn't enough action, and not all players can match their characters' charismatic ways or gift of gab. These rolls may come in handy in such circumstances.

Courtly Etiquette

The intrigues and subtleties of changeling society — whether part of the Seelie or Unseelie Court — may need explaining. In like manner, some interactions with humans might be puzzling to a character. Whether trying to figure out what to wear to court or a fancy ball, or trying to evaluate how canny a character is when judging her peers, a roll on Etiquette can help the player through awkward situations he might not know how to handle, but that his character would sail through with ease.

The player rolls Perception + Etiquette (difficulty 6) to get the subtleties or hidden meanings of others' actions. With a Manipulation + Etiquette roll (difficulty 7), the character could manage an unanswerable insult or barb on a rival — sometimes scoring a major hit of which the target is unaware, or is too embarrassed to answer.

Credibility

If the character tries to convince someone she is telling the truth, the Storyteller may have the player make a Manipulation + Empathy roll. The difficulty is the listener's Intelligence + Subterfuge. The Storyteller should consider the situation when assigning any penalties or bonuses to the roll. Is the character trying to convince a police officer she is who she says she is? Is she testifying before a jury? Lower the difficulty if the character is actually telling the truth. Truthfulness requires fewer behavioral props and does not reveal any of the characteristic "tells" that indicate a lie.

Each success results in a higher level of believability. The subject is totally convinced at five successes. A failure indicates disbelief and a botch means the character is caught in a lie — or the listener thinks he has caught her lying.

Facedown

When two characters engage in a duel of personal will and neither wants to back down, use this system. No words are exchanged between the two; they just stare menacingly or mockingly at one another. Sidhe claim to be the masters of this technique, though trolls often give as good as they get — and redcaps remain the undisputed experts.

Both participants roll Charisma + Intimidation; this is a resisted roll. The one with the most successes wins. The loser looks away. A player can spend a Willpower point each turn to avoid giving up or losing, until the character runs out of Willpower.

There may be times when one or both contestants try to trick the opponent into giving up, such as a pooka making funny faces to crack up the other character. The Storyteller may ask for an additional roll under these circumstances.

Fast-Talk

Using Fast-Talk, a character tries to browbeat or bamboozle someone into submission. The player usually rolls Manipulation + Subterfuge, though Charisma or Appearance could be used instead paired with Expression, Intimidation, or whatever Ability the Storyteller thinks is appropriate. The difficulty is the target's Willpower, and success indicates that the subject becomes confused.

The target of Fast-Talk may make a resisted Wits + Subterfuge roll. If the character using Fast-Talk fails her roll, her attempt falters, giving the subject the chance to try to explain himself or Fast-Talk back. This can continue until the original character fails or botches or until the subject does so. Repeated rolls might be necessary to truly cause confusion in one or the other. A botch by someone using Fast-Talk means the subject does not become confused, but becomes angry instead. Fast-Talk attempts by the one that botched will never work against that particular opponent again.

Interrogation

Sidhe, sluagh, and redcaps excel at interrogation. In essence, this is a form of intensive questioning, not torture. Naturally, a little Intimidation goes a long way, however.

The interrogator's player makes a Manipulation + Intimidation roll (difficulty of the victim's Willpower). The number of successes indicates how much information is given. A failure means the interrogator learns nothing, while a botch indicates that the subject is now worthless to the interrogator — he might have suffered a mental breakdown or a heart attack and thus become unable to speak, or maybe he's so unimpressed by the interrogator that he's willing to weather whatever harsh punishment she can dish out.

A victim may make a resisted Willpower roll to avoid revealing anything. Most interrogators know, however, that the odds are on their side.

Oration

After a long battle to reclaim her freehold, the victorious lord of the freehold faces his subjects with the need to reassure the commoners that he intends to rule fairly. The player can make this speech in character, but can still choose to roll dice to determine the speech's effects on the crowd. The player should describe what the character says or wants to accomplish and maybe something about the arguments he would use, perhaps even a memorable phrase he'd like to work into it ("...we must all hang together or we shall assuredly all hang separately").

The player makes a Charisma + Leadership roll. The mood of the crowd or its willingness to hear the speech determines the difficulty. A few things may modify it. The orator's point of view may be unpopular or he might have a reputation of one sort or another. Sometimes the speaker's Appearance may make others more willing to listen.

The number of successes determines how impressed the crowd is, but the player has only one chance at the roll. A failure indicates that the crowd simply ignores the character,